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Methods and apparatus for decoding received uplink transmissions using log-likelihood ratio (LLR) optimization

Abstract

Methods and apparatus for decoding received uplink transmissions using log-likelihood ratio optimization. In an embodiment, a method includes soft-demapping resource elements based on soft-demapping parameters as part of a process to generate log-likelihood ratios (LLR) values, decoding the LLRs to generate decoded data, and identifying a target performance value. The method also includes determining a performance metric from the decoded data, and performing a machine learning algorithm that dynamically adjusts the soft-demapping parameters to move the performance metric toward the target performance value.

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Background/Summary

PRIORITY (1) This is a continuation patent application of U.S. patent application having a U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/173,041, filed on Feb. 10, 2021 in the name of the same inventor and entitled "Methods and Apparatus for Decoding Received Uplink Transmissions Using Log-Likelihood Ratio (LLR) Optimization," issued into a U.S. patent with a U.S. Pat. No. 11,558,147 on Jan. 17, 2023, which further claims priority from U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/975,080 filed on Feb. 11, 2020 and entitled "Log-Likelihood Ratio (LLR) Optimization for 5G by Machine Learning," all of which are hereby incorporated herein by reference in their entireties.

FIELD

(1) The exemplary embodiments of the present invention relate to operation of telecommunications

networks. More specifically, the exemplary embodiments of the present invention relate to receiving and processing data streams using a wireless telecommunication network.

BACKGROUND

(2) With a rapidly growing trend of mobile and remote data access over a high-speed communication network such as Long Term Evolution (LTE), fourth generation (4G), fifth generation (5G) cellular services, accurately delivering and deciphering data streams become increasingly challenging and difficult. The high-speed communication network, which is capable of delivering information includes, but is not limited to, wireless networks, cellular networks, wireless personal area networks (“WPAN”), wireless local area networks (“WLAN”), wireless metropolitan area networks (“MAN”), or the like. While WPAN can be Bluetooth or ZigBee, WLAN may be a Wi-Fi network in accordance with IEEE 802.11 WLAN standards.

(3) In 5G systems, reference signals, data, and uplink control information (UCI) may be included in uplink transmissions from user equipment. The reference signals (RS) are used to estimate channel conditions or for other purposes. However, the reference signals are mixed in with data so that the reference signals must be accounted for when the data and/or UCI information is processed. For example, when processing resource elements (REs) received in an uplink transmission, special processing may be needed to skip over resource elements that contain reference signals. Even if the reference signals are set to zero or empty, their resource elements still need to be accounted for when processing the received data. It is also desirable to provide efficient descrambling, combining, and decoding functions to process received uplink transmissions.

(4) Therefore, it is desirable to have a system that enables efficient processing of data and UCI information received in uplink transmissions.

SUMMARY

(5) In various exemplary embodiments, methods and apparatus are provided for a decoding system that enables fast and efficient processing of received 4G and/or 5G uplink transmissions. In various exemplary embodiments, a decoder is provided that decodes received uplink transmissions using log-likelihood ratio (LLR) optimization.

(6) In an embodiment, a resource element identifier indexes and categorizes uplink control information (UCI) of received uplink symbols into one of three categories. For example, the UCI information comprises hybrid automatic repeat request (“HARQ”) acknowledgements (“ACK”), first channel state information (“CSI1”), and second channel state information (CSI2). For example, category 0 is data or CSI2 information, category 1 is ACK information, and category 2 is CSI1 information. In one embodiment, the categorization information is forwarded to a combiner/extractor that receives descrambled resource elements. The categorization information is used to identify and combine uplink control information from the descrambled resource elements for each symbol. For example, resource elements containing ACK are combined, resource elements containing CSI1 are combined, and resource elements containing CSI2 are combined. The combining is performed over a selected number of received symbols.

(7) In an embodiment, a decoder system is provided includes LLR preprocessors that divide an LLR stream into separate data and CSI2 LLR streams. Separate decoders decode the streams to generate decoded information. Thus, in various exemplary embodiments, received uplink control information is descrambled, combined, and decoded to obtain UCI information to provide efficient processing and enhanced system performance.

(8) In an embodiment, a method is provided that includes soft-demapping resource elements based on soft-demapping parameters as part of a process to generate log-likelihood ratios (LLR) values, decoding the LLRs to generate decoded data, and identifying a target performance value. The method also includes determining a performance metric from the decoded data, and performing a machine learning algorithm that dynamically adjusts the soft-demapping parameters to move the performance metric toward the target performance value.

(9) In an embodiment, an apparatus is provided that includes a soft-demapper configured to soft-

demap resource elements based on soft-demapping parameters as part of a process to generate log-likelihood ratio (LLR) values, a decoder configured to decode data from the LLRs. The apparatus also includes a machine learning circuit configured to: identify a target performance value; determine a performance metric from the decoded data; and perform a machine learning algorithm that dynamically adjusts the soft-demapping parameters to move the performance metric toward the target performance value.

(10) In an embodiment, an apparatus is provided that includes means for soft-demapping resource elements based on soft-demapping parameters as part of a process to generate log-likelihood ratios (LLR) values; means for decoding the LLRs to generate decoded data; means for identifying a target performance value; means for determining a performance metric from the decoded data; and means for performing a machine learning algorithm that dynamically adjusts the soft-demapping parameters to move the performance metric toward the target performance value.

(11) Additional features and benefits of the exemplary embodiments of the present invention will become apparent from the detailed description, figures and claims set forth below.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The exemplary aspects of the present invention will be understood more fully from the detailed description given below and from the accompanying drawings of various embodiments of the invention, which, however, should not be taken to limit the invention to the specific embodiments, but are for explanation and understanding only.

(2) FIG. 1 shows a block diagram of a communication network in which resource elements received in uplink transmissions from user equipment are descrambled and combined by exemplary embodiments of a descrambling and combining system.

(3) FIG. 2 shows an exemplary detailed embodiment of a descrambling and combining system.

(4) FIG. 3 shows a block diagram illustrating a detailed exemplary embodiment of an RE identifier block shown in FIG. 2.

(5) FIG. 4A shows a block diagram illustrating a detailed exemplary embodiment of a descrambler shown in FIG. 2.

(6) FIG. 4B shows a block diagram illustrating operations performed by the descrambler shown in FIG. 4A.

(7) FIG. 5A shows a block diagram illustrating an exemplary embodiment of a combiner/extractor shown in FIG. 2.

(8) FIG. 5B shows a block diagram illustrating operations performed by the combiner/extractor shown in FIG. 5A.

(9) FIG. 6 shows an exemplary method for performing resource element categorization in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a resource element identification system.

(10) FIG. 7 shows an exemplary method for performing descrambling in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a descrambling and combining system.

(11) FIG. 8 shows an exemplary method for performing combining in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a descrambling and combining system.

(12) FIGS. 9A-B shows an exemplary method for performing combining in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a descrambling and combining system.

(13) FIG. 10A shows an exemplary block diagram of a decoder system.

(14) FIG. 10B shows an exemplary detailed diagram illustrating an embodiment of an LLR stream that is input to the decoder system shown in FIG. 10A.

(15) FIG. 11 shows an exemplary method for performing decoding in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a decoder system.

(16) FIG. 12 shows an exemplary embodiment of a portion of the descrambling and combining system shown in FIG. 2.

(17) FIG. 13 shows an exemplary detailed embodiment of a machine learning circuit shown in FIG. 12.

(18) FIG. 14 shows an exemplary embodiment of the parameter table shown in FIG. 13

(19) FIG. 15 shows an exemplary embodiment of a soft-demapper circuit for use in embodiments of the invention.

(20) FIG. 16 shows exemplary graphs that illustrate the operation of the system.

(21) FIG. 17 shows an exemplary method for performing a machine learning algorithm to optimize performance in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a decoder system.

(22) FIG. 18 shows an exemplary method for performing a machine learning algorithm in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a machine learning circuit.

(23) FIG. 19 shows a block diagram illustrating a processing system having an exemplary embodiment of a decoder system that includes a machine learning circuit.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(24) Aspects of the present invention are described below in the context of methods and apparatus for processing uplink information received in a wireless transmission.

(25) The purpose of the following detailed description is to provide an understanding of one or more embodiments of the present invention. Those of ordinary skills in the art will realize that the following detailed description is illustrative only and is not intended to be in any way limiting. Other embodiments will readily suggest themselves to such skilled persons having the benefit of this disclosure and/or description.

(26) In the interest of clarity, not all of the routine features of the implementations described herein are shown and described. It will, of course, be understood that in the development of any such actual implementation, numerous implementation-specific decisions may be made in order to achieve the developer's specific goals, such as compliance with application and business related constraints, and that these specific goals will vary from one implementation to another and from one developer to another. Moreover, it will be understood that such a development effort might be complex and time-consuming, but would nevertheless be a routine undertaking of engineering for those of ordinary skills in the art having the benefit of embodiments of this disclosure.

(27) Various embodiments of the present invention illustrated in the drawings may not be drawn to scale. Rather, the dimensions of the various features may be expanded or reduced for clarity. In addition, some of the drawings may be simplified for clarity. Thus, the drawings may not depict all of the components of a given apparatus (e.g., device) or method. The same reference indicators will be used throughout the drawings and the following detailed description to refer to the same or like parts.

(28) The term “system” or “device” is used generically herein to describe any number of components, elements, sub-systems, devices, packet switch elements, packet switches, access switches, routers, networks, modems, base stations, eNB (eNodeB), computer and/or communication devices or mechanisms, or combinations of components thereof. The term “computer” includes a processor, memory, and buses capable of executing instruction wherein the computer refers to one or a cluster of computers, personal computers, workstations, mainframes, or combinations of computers thereof.

(29) IP communication network, IP network, or communication network means any type of network having an access network that is able to transmit data in a form of packets or cells, such as ATM (Asynchronous Transfer Mode) type, on a transport medium, for example, the TCP/IP or UDP/IP type. ATM cells are the result of decomposition (or segmentation) of packets of data, IP type, and those packets (here IP packets) comprise an IP header, a header specific to the transport medium (for example UDP or TCP) and payload data. The IP network may also include a satellite network, a DVB-RCS (Digital Video Broadcasting-Return Channel System) network, providing

Internet access via satellite, or an SDMB (Satellite Digital Multimedia Broadcast) network, a terrestrial network, a cable (xDSL) network or a mobile or cellular network (GPRS/EDGE, or UMTS (where applicable of the MBMS (Multimedia Broadcast/Multicast Services) type, or the evolution of the UMTS known as LTE (Long Term Evolution), or DVB-H (Digital Video Broadcasting-Handhelds)), or a hybrid (satellite and terrestrial) network.

(30) FIG. 1 shows a block diagram of a communication network **100** in which resource elements received in uplink transmissions from user equipment are decoded by exemplary embodiments of a decoder system **156**. The network **100** includes packet data network gateway (“P-GW”) **120**, two serving gateways (“S-GWs”) **121-122**, two base stations (or cell sites) **102-104**, server **124**, and Internet **150**. P-GW **120** includes various components **140**, such as billing module **142**, subscribing module **144**, and/or tracking module **146** to facilitate routing activities between sources and destinations. It should be noted that the underlying concept of the exemplary embodiments would not change if one or more blocks (or devices) were added to or removed from network **100**.

(31) The network **100** may operate as a fourth generation (“4G”), Long Term Evolution (LTE), Fifth Generation (5G), New Radio (NR), or combination of 4G and 5G cellular network configurations. Mobility Management Entity (MME) **126**, in one aspect, is coupled to base stations (or cell site) and S-GWs capable of facilitating data transfer between 4G LTE and 5G. MME **126** performs various controlling/managing functions, network securities, and resource allocations.

(32) S-GW **121** or **122**, in one example, coupled to P-GW **120**, MME **126**, and base stations **102** or **104**, is capable of routing data packets from base station **102**, or eNodeB, to P-GW **120** and/or MME **126**. A function of S-GW **121** or **122** is to perform an anchoring function for mobility between 3G and 4G equipment. S-GW **122** is also able to perform various network management functions, such as terminating paths, paging idle UEs, storing data, routing information, generating replica, and the like.

(33) P-GW **120**, coupled to S-GWs **121-122** and Internet **150**, is able to provide network communication between user equipment (“UE”) and IP based networks such as Internet **150**. P-GW **120** is used for connectivity, packet filtering, inspection, data usage, billing, or PCRF (policy and charging rules function) enforcement, et cetera. P-GW **120** also provides an anchoring function for mobility between 4G and 5G packet core networks.

(34) Base station **102** or **104**, also known as cell site, node B, or eNodeB, includes one or more radio towers **110** or **112**. Radio tower **110** or **112** is further coupled to various UEs, such as a cellular phone **106**, a handheld device **108**, tablets and/or iPad® **107** via wireless communications or channels **137-139**. Devices **106-108** can be portable devices or mobile devices, such as iPhone®, BlackBerry®, Android®, and so on. Base station **102** facilitates network communication between mobile devices, such as UEs **106-107**, with S-GW **121** via radio towers **110**. It should be noted that base station or cell site could include additional radio towers as well as other land switching circuitry.

(35) To improve efficiency and/or speed-up processing of uplink control information received in uplink transmissions from user equipment, the decoder system **156** is provided to decode data and UCI information received in uplink transmissions. A more detailed description of the decoder system **156** is provided below.

(36) FIG. 2 shows an exemplary detailed embodiment of an RE1 system **152**. FIG. 2 shows user equipment (“UE”) **224** having antenna **222** that allows wireless communication with base station **112** through wireless transmissions **226**. The UE **224** transmits uplink communications **230** that are received by base station front end (FE) **228**. In an embodiment, the base station includes gain normalizer **202**, inverse transform block (IDFT) **204**, configuration parameters **222**, processing type detector **208**, RS remover **210**, layer demapper **212**, despreader **214**, and the RE1 system **152**. In an embodiment, the RE1 system **152** comprises, RE identifier **232**, soft-demapper **216**, SINR calculator **234** and a descrambling and combining system (DCS) **154**. In an embodiment, the DCS **154** comprises descrambler **218** and combiner/extractor **220**. In an embodiment, combined data and

UCI information output from the DCS **154** is input to the decoder system **156** that outputs decoded information. In an embodiment, a machine learning circuit (MLC) **250** is provided that receives the decoded data/UCI **252** and generates a performance metric that is used by a machine learning algorithm to determine updated soft-demapper parameters **256** that are used to perform soft-demapping to achieve selected system performance.

(37) In an embodiment, the receiver of the uplink transmission processes **1** symbol at a time, which may come from multiple layers for NR, and the receiver of the uplink transmission processes the whole subframe or slot of a layer for LTE covering 1 ms transmission time interval (TTI), 7-OFDM symbol (OS) short(s) TTI, and 2/3-OS sTTI. The modulation order can be derived as follows. 1.

($\pi/2$) BPSK for NR 2. ($\pi/2$) BPSK for LTE sub-PRB, QPSK, 16QAM, 64QAM, and 256QAM

(38) Furthermore, demapping rules apply to constellations as defined in LTE (4G) and/or NR (5G) Standards.

(39) Configuration Parameters (Block **222**)

(40) In an embodiment, the configuration parameters **222** comprise multiple fields that contain parameters for use by multiple blocks shown in FIG. **2**. For example, some of the configuration parameters **222** control the operation of the gain normalizer **202**, IDFT **204**, RE1 system **152**, and decoder system **156**. In an embodiment, the configuration parameters **222** may indicate that the gain normalizer **202** and the IDFT **204** are to be bypassed. In an embodiment, the configuration parameters **222** are used by the soft-demapper **216** to determine when to apply special treatment when soft-demapping received resource elements. The configuration parameters **222** are also used to control the operation of the descrambler **218**, combiner/extractor **220**, and/or the SINR calculator **234**.

(41) Gain Normalizer (Block **202**)

(42) In an embodiment, the gain normalizer **202** performs a gain normalization function on the received uplink transmission. For example, the gain normalizer **202** is applicable to LTE and NR DFT-s-OFDM cases. Input samples will be normalized as follows per data symbol per subcarrier with a norm gain value calculated per symbol as follows.

$\text{Gainnorm_out}[\text{Ds}][\text{sc}] = (\text{Gainnorm_in}[\text{Ds}][\text{sc}]) / (\text{Norm_Gain}[\text{Ds}])$

IDFT (Block **204**)

(43) The IDFT **204** operates to provide an inverse transform to generate time domain signals. In an embodiment, the IDFT **204** is enabled only for LTE and NR DFT-s-OFDM and LTE sub-PRB. In an embodiment, the inputs and outputs are assumed to be 16-bit I and Q values, respectively. The DFT and IDFT operations are defined as follows.

(44) DFT: $X[k] = \frac{1}{\sqrt{N}} \sum_{n=0}^{N-1} x[n] W_N^{kn}$ and IDFT: $X[k] = \frac{1}{\sqrt{N}} \sum_{n=0}^{N-1} x[n] W_N^{kn}$

where $W_N = e^{-2\pi j/N}$.

Processing Type Detector (Block **208**)

(45) In exemplary embodiments, the processing type detector **214** detects the type of processing to be performed by the system. For example, this information may be detected from the configuration parameters **222**. In an embodiment, the processing type detector **208** operates to detect one of two processing types, which cover the operation of the system as follows. 1. Type 1-5G NR DFT-s-OFDM 2. Type 1-5G NR CP-OFDM 3. Type 2-5G NR PUCCH Format **4**

RS Remover (Block **210**)

(46) In an embodiment, the RS remover **210** operates during Type 1 processing to remove RS resource elements from the received data stream to produce a stream of data that is input to the layer demapper. For example, the RE locations of the RS symbols are identified and the data is rewritten into one or more buffers to remove the RS symbols to produce an output that contains only data/UCI. In an embodiment, Type 1 processing includes RS/DTX removal, layer demapping with an interleaving structure, soft-demapping, and descrambling. A benefit of removal of the RS REs before layering is to enable a single shot descrambling process without any disturbance in a

continuous fashion with no extra buffering.

(47) Layer Demapper (Block **212**)

(48) In an embodiment, data and signal to interference noise ratio (SINR) coming from multiple layers of a certain subcarrier will be transferred into a layer demapping circuit (not shown) via multi-threaded read DMA operation. In this case, each thread will point to the memory location of different layers for a certain symbol. The layer demapper **212** produces demapped data and multiple pSINR reports per layer. In an embodiment, for NR the DMRS/PTRS/DTX REs will be removed from the information stream prior to soft-demapping for both I/Q and SINR samples.

(49) Despreader (Block **214**)

(50) In an embodiment, the despreader **214** provides despreading Type 2 processing for PUCCH Format **4** only. Despreading comprises combining the repeated symbols along the frequency axis upon multiplying them with the conjugate of the proper spreading sequence. The spreading sequence index as well as the spreading type for combining the information in a correct way will be given by the configuration parameters **222**. This process is always performed over 12 REs in total. The number of REs that will be pushed into subsequent blocks will be reduced by half or ¼th after despreading depending upon the spreading type. Combined results will be averaged and stored as 16-bit information before soft-demapping.

(51) RE1 System (Block **152**)

(52) In an embodiment, the RE1 system **152** comprises, the RE identifier **232**, the soft-demapper **216**, the descrambler **218**, the combiner/extractor **220**, and the SINR calculator **234**. During operation the RE1 system **152** categorizes resource elements and passes these categorized REs to the soft-demapper **216** and one or more other blocks of the RE1 system **152**. In an embodiment, the soft-demapper **216** uses the categorized REs to determine when to apply special treatment to the soft-demapping process.

(53) In another embodiment, described in more detail below, the RE identifier **232** receives request for hypothesis index values for resource elements containing data/CSI2 information. The RE identifier **232** processes these requests to determine whether the RE contains data or a CSI2 value, and if the RE contains a CSI2 value by providing a hypothesis index value associated with the CSI2 value.

(54) Resource Element Identifier (Block **232**)

(55) In an embodiment, the RE identifier **232** operates to process a received information stream of resource elements to identify, index, and categorized each element. An index and categorization of each element (e.g., RE information **236**) is passed to the soft-demapper **216** and other blocks of the RE1 system **152**. A more detailed description of the operation of the RE identifier **232** is provided below.

(56) FIG. **3** shows a block diagram illustrating a detailed exemplary embodiment of the RE identifier **232** shown in FIG. **2**. As illustrated in FIG. **3**, the RE identifier **232** comprises RE input interface **302**, parameter receiver **304**, categorizer **306**, and RE output interface **308**.

(57) During operation, an uplink transmission is received and processed by the above described blocks to produce an information stream, such as the information stream **312**. For example, the received uplink transmission is processed by at least one of the processing type detector **208**, layer demapper **212**, or the despreader **214**. As a result, the information stream **312** does not contain any reference signals (RS) but contains data or data multiplexed with UCI information and this stream is input to the RE identifier **232**.

(58) The information stream **312**, in one embodiment, includes information or data bits and UCI bits. In one example, the UCI bits, such as ACK bits, CSI1 bits, and/or data/CSI2 bits, are scattered throughout information stream **312**. For instance, UCI bits are mixed with the data bits as illustrated.

(59) In an embodiment, during 5G operation, the RE identifier **232** correctly identifies the RE indices of the UCI bits for soft-demapper special treatment, descrambler code modification, and

UCI combining/extraction as shown in FIG. 2. The RE indices of the UCI bits are also used for generating the SINR report values for ACK and CSI1 as well for NR CP-OFDM operation.

(60) In an embodiment, the RE identification process will process 2 REs per cycle, indicated at **314**. For example, the resource elements of the received stream **312** are received by the RE input interface **302**, which provides the received information to the categorizer **306**. The parameter receiver **304** receives parameters **310** from the configuration parameter block **222**. The categorizer **306** uses these parameters to categorize the received resource elements and after categorizing the received REs, the categorizer **306** stores the categorized REs in an array, such as the array **316**, which shows index, RE value, and category. In an embodiment, the identification of RE1 can be obtained based on multiple hypotheses of RE0. Similarly, RE2 identification can be derived based on multiple hypotheses of RE0 and RE1. The RE output interface **308** outputs the categorized REs to the soft-demapper **216**, descrambler **218**, UCI combiner **220**, and SINR calculator **234**. In one aspect, the components of soft-demapper **216**, descrambler **218**, UCI combiner **220**, and SINR calculator **234** are interconnected for transferring certain information between the components.

(61) In an exemplary embodiment, the RE identifier **232** receives a request **318** for a hypothesis index value for an RE that contains data/CSI2 information. The request is received from the combiner/extractor **220**. In response to the request **318**, the RE identifier **232** determines if the RE contains data or CSI2 information. If the RE contains CSI2 information, a hypothesis index value associated with the CSI2 value is determined. In an embodiment, there are up to eleven (0-10) hypotheses associated with the CSI2 information. The RE identifier **232** then outputs the determined hypothesis index value **320** to the combiner/extractor for further processing.

(62) Referring again to FIG. 2, in various embodiments, the soft-demapper **216** provides special treatment to REs based on certain UCI categories. The descrambler **218** is capable of providing scrambling code modification based on certain UCI categories. The UCI combiner/extractor **220** is capable of combining DATA, ACK, CSI1, and/or CSI2 information. The SINR calculator **234** is capable of calculating data/CSI2 SINR, as well as other RE related SINRs, such as an ACK SINR and a CSI SINR.

(63) Soft-Demapper

(64) The soft-demapping principle is based on computing the log-likelihood ratio (LLR) of a bit that quantifies the level of certainty on whether it is logical zero or one. The soft-demapper **216** processes symbol by symbol and RE by RE within a symbol.

(65) The soft-demapping principle is based on computing the log-likelihood ratio (LLR) of a bit that quantifies the level of certainty on whether it is logical zero or one. Under the assumption of Gaussian noise, LLR for the i-th bit is given by:

$$(66) \quad LLR_i = \ln\left(\frac{P(\text{bit} = 0/r)}{P(\text{bit} = 1/r)}\right) = \ln\left(\frac{\prod_j \text{Math}.j \cdot e^{\frac{-(x-c_j)^2}{2}}}{\prod_k \text{Math}.k \cdot e^{\frac{-(x-c_k)^2}{2}}}\right) = \ln\left(\prod_j \text{Math}.j \cdot e^{\frac{-(x-c_j)^2}{2}}\right) - \ln\left(\prod_k \text{Math}.k \cdot e^{\frac{-(x-c_k)^2}{2}}\right) \quad \text{EQ. 1}$$

where c.sub.j and c.sub.k are the constellation points for which i-th bit takes the value of 0 and 1, respectively. Note that for the gray mapped modulation schemes given in [R1], x may be taken to refer to a single dimension I or Q. Computation complexity increases linearly with the modulation order. A max-log MAP approximation has been adopted in order to reduce the computational complexity. Note that this approximation is not necessary for QPSK since its LLR has only one term on both numerator and denominator.

$$(67) \quad \ln \prod_m \text{Math}.m \cdot e^{-d_m} \cong \max(-d_m) = \min(d_m)$$

(68) This approximation is accurate enough especially in the high SNR region and simplifies the LLR calculation drastically avoiding the complex exponential and logarithmic operations. Given that I and Q are the real and imaginary parts of the input samples, the soft LLR is defined as follows for (π/2) BPSK, QPSK, 16QAM, 64QAM, and 256QAM, respectively.

(69) In an embodiment, the soft-demapper **216** includes a first minimum function component (“MFC”), a second MFC, a special treatment component (“STC”), a subtractor, and/or an LLR

generator. A function of soft-demapper **216** is to demap or ascertain soft bit information associated to received symbols or bit streams. For example, soft-demapper **216** employs soft-demapping principle which is based on computing the log-likelihood ratio (LLR) of a bit that quantifies the level of certainty as to whether it is a logical zero or one. To reduce noise and interference, soft-demapper **216** is also capable of discarding one or more unused constellation points relating to the frequency of the bit stream from the constellation map.

(70) The STC, in one aspect, is configured to force an infinity value as one input to the first MFC when the stream of bits is identified and a special treatment is needed. For example, a predefined control signal with a specific set of encoding categories such as ACK with a set of predefined encoding categories requires a special treatment. One of the special treatments, in one aspect, is to force infinity values as inputs to MFCs. For example, STC force infinity values as inputs to the first and the second MFCs when the stream of bits is identified as ACK or CSI1 with a predefined encoding category. The STC, in one instance, is configured to determine whether a special treatment (or special treatment function) is required based on received bit stream or symbols. In one aspect, the 1-bit and 2-bit control signals with predefined encoding categories listed in Table 1 require special treatments. It should be noted that Table 1 is exemplary and that other configurations are possible.

(71) TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 Control Signal with Renamed No. Encoding Categories
Categories 1 O.sup.ACK = 1 ACK[1] 2 O.sup.ACK = 2 ACK[2] 3 O.sup.CSI1 = 1 CSI1[1] 4
O.sup.CSI1 = 2 CSI1[2]

SINR Calculator (Block **234**)

(72) The SINR calculator **234** calculates SINR for per UCI type based on categories received from RE1 block **232**.

(73) Descrambler (Block **218**)

(74) The descrambler **218** is configured to generate a descrambling sequence of bits or a stream of bits. For example, after generating a sequence in accordance with the input value, the descrambler determines whether a descrambling sequence modification is needed for certain categories of control information to be descrambled. For example, the descrambler **218** receives the categorized RE information **236** from the RE identifier **232** and uses this information to determine when descrambling sequence modification is required. In an embodiment, the descrambler also provides for storage of intermediate linear feedback shift register (LFSR) states to facilitate continuous descrambling sequence generation over multiple symbols. The descrambled resource elements **244** of the symbols are passed to the combiner/extractor **220** along with corresponding descrambling sequences **246**. A more detailed description of the descrambler **218** is provided below.

(75) Combiner/Extractor (Block **220**)

(76) The combiner/extractor **220** provides a combining and extracting function to combine descrambled soft bits from the descrambler **218** and extract uplink control information. In an embodiment, the combiner/extractor **220** modifies its operation based on categories received from RE1 block **232**. A more detailed description of the combiner/extractor **220** is provided below.

(77) Decoder System (Block **156**)

(78) The decoder system **156** decodes the raw LLR and combined data/UCI information **254** received from the combiner/extractor **220**. In an embodiment, the decoder system **156** divides the combined data and CSI2 information into separate LLR streams based on the configuration parameters **222**. The decoder system **156** then decodes each stream separately to generate decoded data and CSI2 (UCI) information **252**. A more detailed description of the decoder system **156** is provided below.

(79) Machine Learning Circuit (MLC) (Block **250**)

(80) In an embodiment, a machine learning circuit **250** is provided that receives the decoded data/UCI information **252** and determines a performance metric. Based on the determined performance metric, the MLC **250** performs a machine learning algorithm to generate updated soft-

demapper parameters **256** that are input to the configuration parameters **222**. In an embodiment, the parameters **256** are input to the soft-demapper **216** and used to determine the soft-demapped REs **242**, which are processed into the raw LLR and combined data/UCI information **254** that is decoded by the decoder system **156**. In an embodiment, the MLC **250** adjusts the soft-demapper parameters **256** until a desired performance metric is obtained. A more detailed description of the MLC **250** is provided below.

(81) FIG. **4A** shows a block diagram illustrating a detailed exemplary embodiment of the descrambler **218** shown in FIG. **2**. In an embodiment, the descrambler **218** comprises a descrambler processor **402**, internal memory **404**, linear feedback shift registers LFSR0 and LFSR1, and output interface **406**. The descrambler processor **402** also includes a sequence modifier **412** that operates to modify descrambling sequences for certain categories of ACK and CSI1 information.

(82) FIG. **4B** shows a block diagram illustrating operations performed by the descrambler **218** shown in FIG. **4A**. During operation, the descrambler processor **402** receives soft-demapped REs **242** from the soft-demapper **216**. The descrambler processor **402** also receives selected configuration parameters **222**, the RE information **236**, and initialization values **416**. In an embodiment, the initialization values **416** are provided by a central processor or other receiver entity and stored as INIT0 **408** and INIT1 **410**. The descrambler processor **402** initializes the LFSR0 and LFSR1 using initialization values INIT0 **408** and INIT1 **410**, respectively. The shift registers LFSR0 and LFSR1 output bits that are used to determine descrambling bits that are used to descramble the received REs **242**. For example, outputs of the shift registers LFSR0 and LFSR1 are mathematically combined by the descrambler processor **402** to determine descrambling bits to be used to descramble the received REs **242**.

(83) As resource elements of a first symbol are received, the descrambler processor **402** uses descrambling bits that are determined from the output of the shift registers to descramble the received REs **242**. For example, as the resource elements of symbol S0 are received, the descrambler processor **402** uses the generated descrambling bits to descramble the received resource elements. As each RE is descrambled (as indicated by the path **418**), the descrambled REs are stored in the internal memory **404**. After descrambling of all the REs of the symbol is completed, the descrambler processor **402** stores the state of the shift registers LFSR0/1 into the external memory **414**. For example, at the end of symbol S0, the state **422** of LFSR0/1 is stored in the external memory **414**. It should also be noted that the sequence modifier **412** could be used to modify descrambling sequences for certain categories of ACK and CSI1 information.

(84) Before REs of the next symbol (e.g., S1) are descrambled, the LFSR state **422** is restored from the external memory **414** and provided as initialization values **416** to the descrambler processor **402**. Thus, the restored state allows the operation of the shift registers to continue from where they left off after the completion of descrambling the previous symbol (e.g., S0). After descrambling the symbol S1, the descrambler processor **402** stores the state of the shift registers (indicated at **424**) into the external memory **414**. Prior to the start of descrambling of the symbol S3, the state **424** is restored to the LFSR registers of the descrambler processor **402** as described above. This process of storing and restoring the shift registers state continues until all the REs of all the symbols have been descrambled. It should be noted that the REs include data or UCI information. For example, symbol S0 includes the ACK **420** information shown in FIG. **4B**. After the REs are descrambled, they are output by the descrambler output interface **406** as the descrambled REs **244** to the combiner/extractor **220**. In an embodiment, the descrambling sequences **246** used to descramble the REs are also provided to the combiner/extractor **220**.

(85) FIG. **5A** shows a block diagram illustrating a detailed exemplary embodiment of the combiner/extractor **220** shown in FIG. **2**. In an embodiment, the combiner/extractor **220** comprises combiner/extractor processor **502** and internal storage **504**. The processor **502** includes hypothesis processor **516**. During operation, the processor **502** receives the RE information **236** and the descrambled REs **244** from the descrambler **218**. The processor **502** also receives descrambling

sequences **246** that were used to descramble the descrambled REs **244**. The processor **502** uses the RE information **236** to determine which REs represent UCI values. For example, the RE information **236** comprises indexed and categorized RE information so that the processor **502** can use this information to determine when selected UCI REs are received.

(86) At the start of a symbol, the processor **502** initializes ACK **508**, CSI1 **510**, and eleven (0-10) hypothesis CSI2 **512** values in the memory **504**. When REs containing ACK and CSI1 information are received, the processor **502** combines this information with values currently in the memory **504**. For example, the processor **502** uses the RE1 information **236** to determine when ACK information bits are received and combines these bits with currently stored ACK bits **508**. This process continues for ACK **508** and CSI1 **510**.

(87) When CSI2 information is received, the **512**, the hypothesis processor **516** operates to determine one of the hypotheses **512** in which to accumulate the CSI2 information. A more detailed description of the operation of the hypothesis processor **516** is provided below.

(88) Once all the REs of a symbol have been received, the combined values are written out to an external memory **514**. Prior to the start of the next symbol, the values in the external memory **514** are returned to the processor **502** and restored to the internal storage **504**. Combining of the UCI values of the next symbol is then performed.

(89) After the UCI information in each symbol is combined, the results are stored in the external memory **514**. The process continues until the UCI information from a selected number of symbols has been combined. Once the combining process is completed, the processor **502** outputs the combined results **506** to a decoder.

(90) FIG. 5B shows a block diagram illustrating operations performed by the combiner/extractor **220** shown in FIG. 5A. In an embodiment, the hypothesis processor **516** receives the descrambled RE stream **244** and the descrambling sequences **246** used to descramble the REs of the descrambled stream. The processor **516** drops or erases ACK information (indicated at **518**) from the descrambled stream **416** to generate a stream that includes only CSI1 and data/CSI2 information. Next the processor **516** drops CSI1 information (indicated at **520**) from the stream to generate the stream that includes only data/CSI2 information. The processor **516** then performs function **522** to identify hypotheses that are associated with the data/CSI2 stream. For example, the processor **516** sends out the request **318** to the RE identifier **232** to identify a hypothesis index value associated with data/CSI2 information. The RE identifier **232** returns identifying information that indicates whether or not the data/CSI2 information comprises data or CSI2 information. If the information contains data, then the data **524** is output for further processing. If the information contains CSI2, then the hypothesis index is received that indicates the hypothesis associated with the CSI2 information. The CSI2 information and its hypothesis **526** are then further processed.

(91) The hypothesis processor **516** receives the CSI2/Hyp **526** and performs further processing. If the hypothesis is in the range of (2-10) as indicated at **530**, the CSI2 information is passed for accumulation in the memory **504**. If the hypothesis is in the range of (0-1), the CSI2 value is input to a rescrumbling function **532** that uses the received descrambling sequence **246** to rescrumble the CSI2 information to recover the CSI2 information **536** prior to descrambling. The descrambling sequence **246** is modified by modifier function **534** to generate a modified descrambling sequence **540**. The modified descrambling sequence **540** is used by a descrambling function **542** to descramble the rescrumbled CSI2 information **536** to generate modified descrambled CSI2 information **544**. The modified CSI2 information is passed for accumulation in the memory **504**.

(92) Combined Soft Output for UCI

(93) In an exemplary embodiment, the output for UCI soft-combining can be summarized as follows.

(94) 1-Bit UCI Case

(95) A. 1 soft-combined UCI output with 16-bit bitwidth B. 1 soft-combined 'x' labeled bit output with 16-bit bitwidth for ACK and only for 16QAM, 64QAM, and 256QAM. struct

UCI_REPORT_1BIT {int16_t uci_soft_combined; int16_t uci_x_soft_combined;//valid only for ACK and 16QAM, 64QAM, 256QAM int16_t reserved [30]; }

For 2-Bit UCI Case A. 3 soft-combined UCI output for 2-bit UCI case with 16-bit bitwidth B. 1 soft-combined 'x' labeled bit output with 16-bit bitwidth for ACK and only for 16QAM, 64QAM, and 256QAM struct UCI_REPORT_2BIT { int16_t uci_soft_combined[3];// c0, c1, c2 int16_t uci_x_soft_combined;// valid only for ACK and 16QAM, 64QAM, 256QAM int16_t reserved[28]; }

For RM Encoding ($3 < \text{OUCI} < 11$) Case A. 1 set of 32 soft-combined UCI output with 16-bit bitwidth as an input to the RM decoder. struct UCI_REPORT_RM {int16_t uci_soft_combined [32]; }

CSI2 Case

(96) In an exemplary embodiment, there will be up to 11 soft-combined results in total each corresponding to a hypothesis. The soft combining methodology for each hypothesis is fixed and given in Table 2 below.

(97) TABLE-US-00002 TABLE 2 CSI2 soft-combining per hypothesis Hypothesis # Soft combining method Hypothesis 0 1-bit soft combining Hypothesis 1 2-bit soft combining Hypothesis 2 to Reed muller (RM) soft Hypothesis 10 combining

(98) Note that LLR modification may be required for hypothesis 0 and hypothesis 1 due to the presence of 'x' and 'y' bits depending upon the modulation type and the scrambling sequence prior to soft combining operation. This is illustrated in Table 3 below.

(99) TABLE-US-00003 TABLE 3 CSI2 combining example for multiple hypothesis Scrambling Hypo2- seq Hypo0 Hypo1 Hypo 10 CSI2 llr0 1 1 1 1 RE llr1 -1 1* -1 -1 llr2 -1 1* 1* -1 llr3 1 1* 1* 1 Stream out 1-bit 2-bit RM along with combiner combiner combiner data input input input llr0 llr0 llr0 llr0 -llr1 llr1 -llr1 -llr1 -llr2 llr2 llr2 -llr2 llr3 llr3 llr3 llr3 *denotes x/y bit modification

(100) FIG. 6 shows an exemplary method 600 for performing resource element categorization in accordance with exemplary embodiments of an RE1 system. For example, the method 600 is suitable for use with the RE1 system 152 shown in FIG. 2.

(101) At block 602, uplink transmissions are received in a 5G communication network. For example, the uplink transmissions are received at the front end 228 shown in FIG. 2.

(102) At block 604, gain normalization is performed. For example, the gain normalization is performed by the gain normalizer 202 shown in FIG. 2.

(103) At block 606, an inverse Fourier transform is performed to obtain time domain signals. For example, this process is performed by the IDFT block 204 shown in FIG. 2.

(104) At block 608, a determination is made as to a type of processing to be performed. For example, a description of two processing types is provided above. If a first type of processing is to be performed, the method proceeds to block 610. If a second type of processing is to be performed, the method proceeds to block 624. For example, this operation is performed by the processing type detector 208 shown in FIG. 2.

(105) At block 624, when the processing type is Type 2, despreading is performed on the received resource elements. For example, this operation is performed by the despreader 214 shown in FIG. 2. The method then proceeds to block 614.

(106) When the processing type is Type 1, the follow operations are performed.

(107) At block 610, the reference signals are removed from the received resource elements. For example, resource elements containing RS/DTX are removed. This operation is performed by the RS remover 210 shown in FIG. 2.

(108) At block 612, layer demapping is performed. For example, the resource elements without RS/DTX are layer demapped. This operation is performed by the layer demapper 212.

(109) At block 614, RE identification and categorization is performed. For example, as illustrated in FIG. 3, the RE identifier 232 receives a stream of REs, categorizes the REs, and then outputs the

array **316** in which the REs are indexed and include categorization values.

(110) At block **616**, soft-demapping is performed. For example, the soft-demapper **216** soft-demaps the REs with special treatment provided based on the categorization of the received REs. The soft-demapper **216** produces a soft-demapped output that is input to the descrambler **218**.

(111) At block **618**, descrambling is performed. For example, the descrambler **218** receives the soft-demapped bits from the soft-demapper **216** and generates descrambled bits. In an embodiment, based on the categorization of the REs, a modified descrambler code is used. In an embodiment, the descrambler **218** operates to save LFSR state between symbols so that continuous descrambling code generation can be provided from symbol to symbol.

(112) At block **620**, combining and extraction of UCI information is performed. For example, the combiner/extractor **220** receives the descrambled bits, combines these bits, and extracts the UCI information. For example, the combiner/extractor **220** utilizes the RE categorization information to identify UCI resource elements and combines these elements into the memory **504**. The combined UCI values are output at the end of the symbol and the memory is reinitialized for the combining UCI of the next symbol.

(113) At block **622**, SINR calculations are performed to calculate data/CSI2, ACK, and CSI1 SINR values.

(114) Thus, the method **600** operates to provide resource element identification and categorization in accordance with the exemplary embodiments. It should be noted that the operations of the method **600** could be modified, added to, deleted, rearranged, or otherwise changed within the scope of the embodiments.

(115) FIG. 7 shows an exemplary method **700** for performing descrambling in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a descrambling and combining system. For example, the method **700** is suitable for use with the DCS **154** shown in FIG. 2.

(116) At block **702**, configuration parameters and initialization values are received by the descrambler **218**. For example, the configuration parameters **222** are received by the descrambler processor **402**. In addition, the initialization values **416** are received by the descrambler processor **402**. In an embodiment, the initialization values **416** are received from a central processing entity at the receiver. In another embodiment, the initialization values **416** are LFSR state information received from the external memory **414**.

(117) At block **704**, one or more linear feedback shift registers are initialized. For example, the processor **402** initializes the registers LFSR0 and LFSR1 with initialization values INIT0 **408** and INIT1 **410**, respectively.

(118) At block **706**, a resource element of a symbol is received. For example, the processor **402** receives a resource element of the symbol S0 as shown in FIG. 4B.

(119) At block **708**, a descrambling code is generated. For example, the processor **402** generates the descrambling code based on the output of the shift registers LFSR0 and LFSR1.

(120) At block **710**, the RE information is accessed by the processor to determine information about the current resource element. For example, the processor **402** accesses information about the current resource element based on the RE information **236** and the parameters **222**.

(121) At block **712**, a determination is made as to whether scrambling code modification should be made. For example, the processor **402** determines if a descrambling code modification is needed to descramble the current resource element based on the RE information **236** and the parameters **222**. If modification of the scrambling code is needed, the method proceeds to block **714**. If no modification is needed, the method proceeds to block **716**.

(122) At block **714**, the scrambling code is modified by the processor **402** as necessary. For example, the sequence modifier **412** modifies the scrambling code for certain types of ACK and CSI1 information.

(123) At block **716**, the RE is descrambled using the scrambling code. For example, the processor **402** descrambles the RE using the current scrambling code.

(124) At block **718**, a determination is made as to whether there are more REs in the current symbol to descramble. For example, the processor **402** makes this determination from the configuration parameters **222** and/or the RE information **236**. If there are no more symbols to descramble, the method proceeds to block **720**. If there are more symbols to descramble in the current symbol, the method proceeds to block **706**.

(125) At block **720**, a determination is made as to whether there are more symbols to descramble. For example, the processor **402** makes this determination from the configuration parameters **222** and/or the RE information **236**. If there are no more symbols to descramble, the method ends. If there are more symbols to descramble, the method proceeds to block **722**.

(126) At block **722**, the LFSR state is stored. For example, the processor **402** pushes the current state of the registers LFSR0 and LFSR1 to the external memory **414**, for example, as shown by **422**.

(127) At block **724**, the LFSR state is restored prior to descrambling the next symbol. For example, the stored LFSR state from the memory **414** is provided to the processor **402** as a new set of initialization values **416** that are used to restore the state of the registers LFSR0 and LFSR1. Thus, the LFSR generates descrambling sequences based on the restored state. The method then proceeds to block **706** where descrambling continues until the desired number of symbols have been descrambled.

(128) Thus, the method **700** operates to provide descrambling in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a descrambling and combining system. It should be noted that the operations of the method **700** could be modified, added to, deleted, rearranged, or otherwise changed within the scope of the embodiments.

(129) FIG. **8** shows an exemplary method **800** for performing combining in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a descrambling and combining system. For example, the method **800** is suitable for use with the DCS **154** shown in FIG. **2**.

(130) At block **802**, initialization of ACK, CSI1, and CSI2 values in a memory is performed. For example, in an embodiment, the processor **502** initializes the values of ACK **508**, CSI1 **510**, and CSI2 **512** in the memory **504**.

(131) At block **804**, a descrambled RE of a symbol is received. For example, the processor **502** receives the descrambled RE **244**.

(132) At block **806**, RE categorization information is received. For example, the processor **502** receives the RE information **236**.

(133) At block **808**, a determination is made as to whether the current RE contains an ACK value. The processor **502** makes this determination from the RE information **236**. If the current RE contains an ACK value the method proceeds to block **810**. If the current RE does not contain an ACK value, the method proceeds to block **812**.

(134) At block **810**, the ACK value contained in the current RE is combined with ACK values in memory. For example, the processor **502** combines the current RE value with the stored ACK value **508** and restores the combined value back into the memory **504**.

(135) At block **812**, a determination is made as to whether the current RE contains a CSI1 value. The processor **502** makes this determination from the RE information **236**. If the current RE contains a CSI1 value the method proceeds to block **814**. If the current RE does not contain a CSI1 value, the method proceeds to block **816**.

(136) At block **814**, the CSI1 value contained in the current RE is combined with CSI1 values in memory. For example, the processor **502** combines the current RE value with the stored CSI1 value **510** and restores the combined value back into the memory **504**.

(137) At block **816**, a determination is made as to whether the current RE contains a CSI2 value. The processor **502** makes this determination from the RE information **236**. If the current RE contains a CSI2 value the method proceeds to block **818**. If the current RE does not contain a CSI2 value, the method proceeds to block **820**.

(138) At block **818**, the CSI2 value contained in the current RE is combined with CSI2 values in memory. For example, the processor **502** combines the current RE value with the one of the stored hypothesis CSI2 values **512** and restores the combined value back into the memory **504**. A detailed description of the combining of CSI2 values is provided with respect to FIGS. **9A-B**.

(139) At block **820**, a determination is made as to whether there are more REs to combine in the current symbol. The processor **502** makes this determination from the RE information **236**. If there are more REs to combine, the method proceeds to block **804**. If there are no more REs to combine, the method proceeds to block **822**.

(140) At block **822**, the accumulated UCI values are pushed to an external memory. For example, the accumulated UCI values are pushed to the external memory **514**.

(141) At block **824**, a determination is made as to whether there are more symbols to combine. In an embodiment, the processor **502** makes this determination from the RE1 information **236**. If there are no more symbols to combine, the method ends. If there are more symbols to combine, the method proceeds to block **826**.

(142) At block **826**, the UCI values stored in the external memory are acquired and input to the processor **502** as new initialization values. For example, the accumulated UCI values stored in the external memory **514** are acquired by the processor **502**. The method then proceeds to block **802** where the acquired UCI values from the external memory are used to initialize the UCI values **508**, **510**, and **512** in the internal storage **504**.

(143) Thus, the method **800** operates to provide combining in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a descrambling and combining system. It should be noted that the operations of the method **800** could be modified, added to, deleted, rearranged, or otherwise changed within the scope of the embodiments.

(144) FIGS. **9A-B** shows an exemplary method **900** for performing combining in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a descrambling and combining system. For example, the method **900** is suitable for use with the DCS **154** shown in FIG. **2**.

(145) Referring now to FIG. **9A**, at block **902**, initialization is performed for ACK, CSI1, and eleven hypothesis CSI2 values stored in a memory. For example, in an embodiment, the processor **502** initializes the ACK **508**, CSI1 **510**, and eleven hypothesis CSI2 values **512** in the memory **504**. In an embodiment, the values used to initialize the memory **504** are received from the external memory **514** (indicated by D).

(146) At block **904**, a descrambled RE of a symbol is received. For example, the processor **502** receives the descrambled RE **244**.

(147) At block **906**, a descrambled sequence is received. For example, the processor **502** receives the descrambling sequence **246**.

(148) At block **908**, RE categorization information is received. For example, the processor **502** receives the RE information **236**.

(149) At block **910**, a determination is made as to whether the RE is an ACK value. If the received RE is an ACK value, the method proceeds to block **912**. If the received RE is not an ACK value, the method proceeds to block **914**.

(150) At block **912**, ACK processing is performed as described in other sections of this document. The method then proceeds to block **938** (indicated by B).

(151) At block **914**, a determination is made as to whether the RE is a CSI1 value. If the received RE is a CSI1 value, the method proceeds to block **916**. If the received RE is not a CSI1 value, the method proceeds to block **918**.

(152) At block **916**, CSI1 processing is performed as described in other sections of this document. The method then proceeds to block **938** (indicated by B).

(153) At block **918**, the RE comprises data/CSI2 and therefore a request for a hypothesis value for the RE is generated. For example, the processor **516** outputs the request **318** to the RE identifier **232** to obtain a hypothesis index valued for the data/CSI2 information. In one embodiment, the

response **320** generated by the RE identifier **232** indicates that the data/CSI2 information is data. In one embodiment, the response **320** generated by the RE identifier **232** indicates that the data/CSI2 information is CSI2 information associated with a selected hypothesis value (e.g., x).

(154) At block **920**, a determination is made as to whether the data/CSI2 information is data. If the response from the RE identifier **232** indicates that the data/CSI2 information is data, the method proceeds to block **922**. If not, the method proceeds to block **924**.

(155) At block **922**, the data is processed as described in other sections of this document. The method then proceeds to block **938** (indicated by B).

(156) At block **924**, a determination is made as to whether the hypothesis index associated with the CSI2 information is in the range of (2-10). If the hypothesis index is in the range of (2-10), the method proceeds to block **926**. If not, the method proceeds to block **928** (indicated by A).

(157) At block **926**, the CSI2 information is accumulated with the appropriate CSI2 information in the memory **504** based on the hypothesis value, as described in other sections of this document. The method then proceeds to block **936** (indicated by B).

(158) Referring now to FIG. **9B**, at block **928**, the current CSI2 information is identified to be associated with either hypothesis 0 or 1.

(159) At block **930**, the CSI2 RE is rescrambled using the received descrambling sequence. For example, the processor **516** uses the received descrambling sequence **246** to rescramble the received scrambled CSI2 RE **528** to generate a rescrambled CSI2 RE **536**.

(160) At block **932**, the descrambling sequence **246** is modified to generate a modified descrambling sequence. The processor **516** performs a modifying function **534** to modify the received descrambling sequence **246** to generate the modified descrambling sequence **540**.

(161) At block **934**, the rescrambled RE is descrambled with the modified descrambling sequence to generate a modified descrambled RE. For example, the processor **516** performs a descrambling function **542** to descramble the rescrambled CSI2 RE **536** to generate the modified descrambled CSI2 RE **544**.

(162) At block **936**, the modified descrambled CSI2 RE **544** is accumulated with the appropriate hypothesis value in the memory **504**.

(163) At block **938**, a determination is made as to whether there are more REs to combine in the current symbol. The processor **502** makes this determination from the RE information **236**. If there are more REs to combine, the method proceeds to block **904** (indicated by C). If there are no more REs to combine, the method proceeds to block **940**.

(164) At block **940**, the accumulated UCI values in the memory **504** are stored in the external memory **514**.

(165) At block **942**, a determination is made as to whether there are more symbols having UCI information to be combined. If there are more symbols having UCI information to be combined (e.g., in the slot or subframe), the method proceeds to block **902** (indicated by D). In this path, the information stored in the external memory **514** is used to initialize the values stored in the memory **504** prior to combining information from additional symbols. If there are no more symbols to combine, the method ends.

(166) Thus, the method **900** operates to provide combining in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a descrambling and combining system. It should be noted that the operations of the method **900** could be modified, added to, deleted, rearranged, or otherwise changed within the scope of the embodiments.

(167) FIG. **10A** shows an exemplary block diagram of the decoder system **156**. In an embodiment, the decoder system **156** comprises an LLR preprocessors **1002A-B**, data decoder **1004**, and CSI2 decoder **1006**. Also shown in FIG. **10** is memory **1008**. In an embodiment, the memory **1008** receives the combined data and UCI information **506** from the combiner/extractor processor **502** shown in FIG. **5**. For example, the memory **1008** receives combined hypothetical CSI2 values **1010** and outputs these values in an LLR stream **1012** to the decoder system **156**.

(168) In 5G or NR, data and UCI LLRs are multiplexed in both time and frequency. UCI is composed of CSI1/CSI2 and ACK fields. In an embodiment, CSI1 and ACK LLRs can be separated and/or removed from the LLR stream. However, the CSI2 LLRs cannot be separated before producing the composite output LLR stream **1012** provided as input to the decoder system **156**. To extract the required LLRs from this composite stream, the LLR pre-processors **1002A-B** perform this operation. For example, in one case, the preprocessor **1002A** extracts the data LLRs from the stream **1012** and drops the remaining LLRs to form a data LLR stream. In another case, the preprocessor **1002B** extracts the CSI2 LLRs and drops the remaining LLRs to form a CSI2 LLR stream.

(169) In an embodiment, the data decoder **1004** decodes the data LLR stream to generate decoded data. The CSI2 decoder **1006** decodes the CSI2 LLR stream to generate decoded CSI2 information. In another embodiment, Reed Muller (RM), 1-bit, or 2-bit encoded CSI2 LLRs (indicated at **1016**) are provided directly to the CSI2 decoder **1006**.

(170) FIG. **10B** shows an exemplary detailed diagram illustrating an embodiment of the LLR stream **1012** that is input to the decoder system **156** in accordance with one embodiment of the present invention. The LLR stream **1012** includes LLRs for CSI2, LLRs for data, and padding LLRs, which are identified in FIG. **10B** by their respective shading. In an embodiment, the LLR preprocessors **1002A-B** perform an algorithm to remove the padding LLRs to generate a second stream **1014** that contains LLRs for data and CSI2. For example, after the padding LLRs are dropped by the pre-processors **1002A-B**, the remaining LLR stream follows a pattern as shown in the stream **1014**.

(171) In an embodiment, there can be up to 3 bursts of CSI2 LLRs and up to 2 bursts of data LLRs alternating with each other in each half slot. Each burst of data LLRs corresponds to a set of data LLRs in a DMRS symbol. In the frequency hopping case, there can be up to 2 DMRS symbols in each half slot and hence two bursts of data LLRs are possible. Each burst of CSI2 LLRs corresponds to a consecutive group of CSI2 LLRs not interrupted by data LLRs.

(172) The burst sizes of CSI2 LLRs are represented by px_a0 , px_a1 , and px_a2 . And the burst sizes of data LLRs are represented by px_b0 and $p1_b1$, respectively. Following these CSI2 and data bursts, there can be periodic and alternating CSI2 and data LLRs repeating “ a_k ” times. Each period starts with CSI2 of length “ px_a_r ” LLRs followed by data of length “ $px_a_d-px_a_r$ ” LLRs. Following this periodic pattern, the rest will be data LLRs until the end of ‘ $num_rd_dma_word_px$ ’. Overall, these bursts are repeated twice. For example, px becomes $p0$ for part 0 and $p1$ for part 1.

(173) Configuration

(174) In an embodiment, the following configuration parameters **222** shown in Table 4 below are used for the operation of the LLR preprocessors **1002A-B** to separate the data and CSI2 LLRs. These parameters will be present in the AB_CFG section of LDPC decoder (LDEC) and polar decoder (PDEC) blocks of the configuration parameters **222**. It is not necessary for all these parameters to show up in the same 64-bit word or in consecutive words.

(175) TABLE-US-00004 TABLE 4 Configuration parameters

Parameter	Width	Description
preproc_mode	1	‘0’: Pass CSI2 LLRs and drop rest ‘1’: Pass data LLRs and drop rest
preproc_p0_csi2_len0	19	CSI2 part 0-burst 0 size. Range: [0:422399]
preproc_p0_csi2_len1	19	CSI2 part 0-burst 1 size. Range: [0:422399]
preproc_p0_csi2_len2	19	CSI2 part 0-burst 2 size. Range: [0:422399]
preproc_p1_csi2_len0	19	CSI2 part 1-burst 0 size. Range: [0:422399]
preproc_p1_csi2_len1	19	CSI2 part 1-burst 1 size. Range: [0:422399]
preproc_p1_csi2_len2	19	CSI2 part 1-burst 2 size. Range: [0:422399]
preproc_p0_data_len0	17	Data part 0-burst 0 size. Range: [0:105599]
preproc_p0_data_len1	17	Data part 0-burst 1 size. Range: [0:105599]
preproc_p1_data_len0	17	Data part 0-burst 0 size. Range: [0:105599]
preproc_p1_data_len1	17	Data part 0-burst 1 size. Range: [0:105599]
preproc_p0_csi2_repeat	16	Periodicity of Repeated CSI2 LLRs followed by part 0 period (3 bursts of CSI2 and 2 bursts of data) LLRs. Represents

number of LLRs of each period. Range: [0:52800] 13 preproc_p1_csi2_repeat_ 16 Periodicity of Repeated CSI2 LLRs followed by part 1 period (3 bursts of CSI2 and 2 bursts of data) LLRs. Represents number of LLRs of each period. Range: [0:52800] 14 preproc_csi2_repeat_ 6 Burst size of CSI2 LLRs in each repeat of both part 0 burst_size and part 1. Range: {1, 2, 3, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12, 16, 18, 20, 24, 30, 32, 40} 15 preproc_p0_num_repeat 11 Number of periodic repetitions in part 0. Range: [0:2047] 16 preproc_p1_num_repeat 11 Number of periodic repetitions in part 1. Range: [0:2047] 17 num_rd_dma_words_p0 32 Number of read DMA words for part 0 18 num_rd_dma_words_p1 32 Number of read DMA words for part 1 19 tb_tx_bit_size 24 Number of LLRs to be sent to the decoder core

LLR Preprocessor Operation

(176) In an exemplary embodiment, the following pseudo-code describes the operation of the LLR pre-processors **1002A-B** of the decoding system to separate data and CSI2 LLRs to the appropriate decoder. For example, the pseudo-code below utilizes configuration parameters shown in Table 4 to remove padding (e.g., “tagged”) LLRs and separate data and CSI2 LLR from an input stream to generate data and CSI2 streams that are passed to the appropriate decoder. If (preproc_mode==0) target=‘csi2’ else target=‘data’ end csi2_count=‘preproc_p0_csi2_len0’

data_count=‘preproc_PO_data_len0’

Step 0: Drop all tagged LLRs.

Step 1: Part 0 Starts Read ‘csi2_count’ csi2 LLRs. If target==‘csi2’ pass LLRs to CSI2 decoder else drop them (remove from stream) end

Step 2: Read ‘data_count’ data LLRs. If target==‘csi2’ drop them else pass remaining to data decoder end

Step 3: Repeat steps 1 and 2 one more time with csi2_count=‘preproc_p0_csi2_len1’ and data count=‘preproc_p0_data_len1’

Step 4: Read ‘preproc_p0_csi2_len2’ csi2 LLRs. If target==‘csi2’ pass them to CSI2 decoder else drop them end

Step 5: Read ‘preproc_csi2_repeat_burst_size’ CSI2 LLRS If target==‘csi2’ pass them to CSI2 decoder else drop them end

Step 6: LLRS Read ‘preproc_p0_csi2_repeat_period-preproc_p0_csi2_repeat_burst_size’ data If target==‘csi2’ drop them else pass them to data decoder end

Step 7: Repeat steps 5 and 6 ‘preproc_p0_num_repeat’ times

Step 8: Part 0 Ends Continue reading rest of data LLRs till ‘num_rd_dma_words_p0’ are read If target==‘csi2’ drop them else if (num_rd_data_llrs< ‘tb_tx_bit_size’) // Number of data LLRs read so far pass them to decoder else drop them.

Step 9: Part 1 Starts Repeats Step 1 to Step 7 by replacing all ‘p0’ with ‘p1’.

Step 10: Part 1 Ends Continue reading rest of data LLRs till

‘num_rd_dma_words_p0+num_rd_dma_words_p1’ are read If target==‘csi2’ drop them else if (num_rd_data_llrs< ‘tb_tx_bit_size’) //Number of data LLRs read so far pass them to decoder else drop them.

(177) FIG. **11** shows an exemplary method **1100** for performing decoding in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a decoder system. For example, the method **1100** is suitable for use with the decoder system **156** shown in FIG. **2**.

(178) At block **1102**, a stream of data, CSI2, and padding LLRs are received. For example, in an embodiment, the stream **1012** is received from the memory **1008** by the decoder **156**. In an embodiment, both LLR pre-processors **1002A-B** receive the stream.

(179) At block **1104**, configuration parameters are received. In an embodiment, the configuration parameters **222** are received by the pre-processors **1002A-B**.

(180) At block **1106**, the padding LLRs are removed from the stream. For example, the pre-processors **1002A-B** remove the padding (“tagged”) LLRs from the stream they have received.

(181) At block **1108**, data and CSI2 LLRs are separated. For example, the pre-processors **1102A-B**

separates the data and CSI2 LLRs based on the received configuration parameters. For example, each of the LLR preprocessors **1102A-B** performs the algorithm above to separate either data or CSI2 LLRs from the stream they have received.

(182) At block **1110**, the data LLRs are decoded. For example, the data decoder **1004** receives and decodes the data LLRs.

(183) At block **1112**, the CSI2 LLRs are decoded. For example, the CSI2 decoder **1006** receives and decodes the CSI2 LLRs.

(184) Thus, the method **1100** operates to provide decoding in accordance with exemplary embodiments. It should be noted that the operations of the method **1100** could be modified, added to, deleted, rearranged, or otherwise changed within the scope of the embodiments.

(185) LLR Optimization Using Machine Learning

(186) The quality and range of LLRs generated by the LLR generator in 5G systems are important for achieving the best possible physical layer performance. In various embodiments, a machine learning circuit operates to provide parameters to a soft-demapping process of the LLR generator to achieve a selected performance target. In an iterative process, the machine learning algorithm adjusts the soft-demapping parameters based on a measured performance metric to move the system performance toward the selected target performance until the target performance is achieved. The machine learning circuit comprises a parameter table which stores the generated soft-demapping parameters after each iteration. The table also provides storage for soft-demapping parameters that are generated for each of multiple decoders operating with multiple modulation coding schemes.

(187) FIG. **12** shows an exemplary embodiment of a portion of the descrambling and combining system shown in FIG. **2**. As illustrated in FIG. **12**, the RE1 system **152** generates raw LLRs **254** and includes the soft-demapper **216**. The RE1 system **152** receives input from either the layer demapper **212** or the despreader **214** and generates the raw LLRs and combined data/UCI information **254**. The RE1 system **152** receives the configuration parameters **222**, which are used to control the operation of the various functional blocks of the RE1 system **152** including the soft-demapper **216**.

(188) In an embodiment, the configuration parameters **222** include the soft-demapping parameters **256** that are passed to the soft-demapper **216** and are used to control the soft-demapping process. A more detailed description of the soft-demapping parameters **256** is provided below.

(189) In a 5G system, LLRs generated by an LLR generator are fed into one or more decoders. For example, in one embodiment, the decoder **156** comprises a turbo decoder (TDEC) block, an LDPC decoder (LDEC) block, and an X decoder (XDEC) block. Any of the decoder blocks may be utilized to generate the decoded data/UCI output **252**. Internal fixed point implementation of all these decoders might be different due to various reasons. In order to ensure the best possible performance from each of these decoders, configuration parameters **222** of the LLR generator are carefully selected.

(190) In an embodiment, the machine learning circuit **250** receives the decoded data/UCI output **252** and determines a performance metric that indicates system performance. In an embodiment, the MLC **250** performs a machine learning algorithm to generate updated soft-demapping parameters **256** that are to be used to adjust the operation of the soft-demapper **216** to move the measured performance toward a desired target performance. In an embodiment, the MLC **250** performs a machine learning algorithm based on a reinforcement learning process to generate the updated parameters **256** to achieve the desired target performance.

(191) FIG. **13** shows an exemplary detailed embodiment of the machine learning circuit **250** shown in FIG. **12**. The machine learning circuit **250** comprises a processor **1302**, memory **1304**, and performance metric circuit **1306** all coupled to communicate over bus **1312**. The memory **1304** comprises performance target(s) **1308** and parameter table **1310**.

(192) Machine Learning Approach

(193) Machine learning approaches are traditionally divided into broad categories, depending on the nature of the “signal” or “feedback” available to the learning system. In an exemplary embodiment, the machine learning algorithm **1314** performs reinforcement learning to interact with a dynamic environment in which it must perform a certain goal (such as adjusting soft-demapper parameters to meet a performance target). As the algorithm navigates the performance space, the algorithm is provided feedback (e.g., a performance metric), which it uses to adjust soft-demapper parameters **256** to move the performance metric toward a performance target **1308**.

(194) Various types of models have been used and researched to implement machine learning systems. In an embodiment, the machine learning algorithm **1314** is implemented by an artificial neural network that interconnects group of nodes, akin to the vast network of neurons in a brain. For example, the processor **1302** performs the algorithm **1314** which implements a neural network to perform the operations described herein.

(195) During operation, the performance measurement circuit **1306** receives the decoded data/UCI **252** and determines one or more performance metrics. For example, the performance metrics can include a block error rate (BLER) or any other suitable performance metric. For example, the performance metric can be a minimal SINR needed to achieve a certain BLER, which can be defined by the user, such as a BLER of 10%. The processor **1302** executes the machine learning algorithm **1314** that adjusts parameters in the parameter table **1310** so that subsequent performance metrics move toward the performance target **1308** until the performance target is reached. Thus, the machine learning algorithm **1314** dynamically adjusts the parameters for the soft-demapper **216** to adjust the performance of the system toward the performance target **1308** without manual intervention. In an embodiment, the target performance is a specific performance level or represents a range of performance.

(196) FIG. **14** shows an exemplary embodiment of the parameter table **1310** shown in FIG. **13**. In an embodiment, the parameters table **1310** includes a column for decoder type **1402**. Each decoder type **1402** includes parameters for a plurality of modulation coding scheme (MCS) values **1404**. The parameters include a modulation (MOD) scale value **1406**, first right shift (RSFT1) value **1408**, a second right shift (RSFT2) value **1410**, LLR offset value **1412**, and a LLR bit-width value **1414**. Based on the decoder type **1402** and MCS value **1404**, the machine learning algorithm **1314** adjusts the soft-demapper parameters **256** to move a performance metric toward a target performance **1308**. For example, the performance metric can be a minimal SINR needed to achieve a certain BLER, which can be defined by the user, such as a BLER of 10%. In an embodiment, the parameters of the parameter table **1310** can be initialized with any desired initial values.

(197) FIG. **15** shows an exemplary embodiment of a soft-demapper circuit **1500** for use in embodiments of the invention. For example, the soft mapper circuit **1500** is suitable for use as at least a portion of the soft-demapper **216**. In an embodiment, the soft-demapper circuit **1500** comprises minimization (MIN) detectors **1502** and **1504**, rounding circuits **1506** and **1508**, LLR offset circuit **1510**, and saturation (SAT) circuit **1512**. The circuit **1500** also comprises multipliers **1514**, **1516**, and **1518**, adder **1520**, and subtractor **1522**.

(198) During operation, received I/Q bits are input to the multiplier **1514**. The multiplier **1514** also receives a selected constant (e.g., 1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 13, and 15) and the multiplied result is a 20-bit value that is input to the adder **1520**. The adder **1520** also receives a constant (MX_CONSTY), which is an unsigned 18-bit value. The adder **1520** outputs the sum of its inputs as a 21-bit value that is input to both minimization circuits **1502** and **1504**. Each minimization circuit outputs the minimum of its inputs. A minimization control circuit **1524** outputs control values to each minimization circuit **1502** and **1504**. The control values control which value is output from each minimization circuit. For example, the minimum value is chosen for a particular modulation format. The outputs of the minimization circuits are input to the subtractor **1522** that subtracts the values and generates a 22-bit output that is input to the multiplier **1516**. In an embodiment, the equation (EQ. 1) is implemented.

(199) A second multiplier **1518** receives a SINR signal that is a 24-bit unsigned value and a modulation scale value that is a 16-bit unsigned value. The product of these signals is input to the rounding circuit **1508** which shifts and rounds its input value based on the first shift value (RSFT1). For example, the following operation is performed to generate an RS1 value.
[Input+(2{circumflex over ()}(RSFT1-1))]>>2{circumflex over ()}RSFT1=40-bit RS1 value;
or

[Input+(2{circumflex over ()}(RSFT1-1))]/2{circumflex over ()}RSFT1=40-bit RS1 value
(200) The RS1 value is input to the multiplier **1516** which multiplies its inputs to generate a 62-bit value that is input to the second rounding circuit **1506**. The rounding circuit **1506** shifts and rounds its input value based on the second shift value (RSFT2). For example, the following operation is performed to generate an RS2 value.

[Input+(2{circumflex over ()}(RSFT2-1))]/2{circumflex over ()}RSFT2=40-bit RS2 value
(201) The LLR offset circuit **1510** receives the RS2 value and an LLR offset value, which is an unsigned (k-1) bit value, and performs an offset operation. The output of the offset circuit **1510** is input to the saturation circuit **1512**. The saturation circuit **1512** receives the LLR_bit_width value and scales its input to prevent saturation to determine the soft-demapped REs **242**, which are processed into the raw LLR and combined data/UCI information **254** that is decoded by the decoder system **156**.

(202) Optimization of the LLR_Bit_Width

(203) Decoders depending upon their internal implementation details can behave differently with different LLR bit widths. In a first operation, the optimal bit width at which the selected decoder achieves its hard decoding performance is determined. In an embodiment, the following operations are performed by processor **1302** to determine an optimal LLR bit width for use during the decoding process. 1. Maximize all multipliers and minimize all dividers forcing the LLRs into saturation. For example, the processor **1302** outputs the parameters to force the LLRs **242** into saturation. 2. Adjust the LLR_bit_width value **1414** for the particular decoder/MCS to achieve the best performance. For example, the processor **1302** adjusts the LLR_bit_width parameters to achieve the best LLR performance. The LLR_bit_width value is then saved in the parameters table **1310**.

Optimization of Parameters Based on Machine Learning

(204) Once the LLR_bit_width parameter is determined, the machine learning algorithm **1314** operates to adjust the remaining soft-demapping parameters to achieve target performance. In an embodiment, the following operations are performed by the machine learning circuit **250** to adjust the soft-demapping parameters. 1. A performance metric is determined by the performance metric circuit **1306**. 2. The target performance **1308** is obtained from the memory **1304**. 3. The machine learning algorithm **1314** utilizes the current performance metric and the target performance to adjust the MOD_SCALE **1406**, RSF1 **1408**, RSFT2 **1410** and LLR_OFFSET **1412** parameters for the particular decoder/MCS to move the performance metric toward the target performance. It should be noted that as a result of the above operations, each decoder will have its own unique set of configuration parameters to achieve an associated target performance. For example, the LLR bit-width parameter **1414** is determined for a particular decoder/MCS. The other parameters are set to initial conditions. The machine learning algorithm **1314** utilizes the current performance metric and the target performance to adjust the MOD_SCALE **1406**, RSF1 **1408**, RSFT2 **1410**, and LLR_OFFSET **1412** parameters for the particular decoder/MCS to move the performance metric toward the target performance in an iterative process until the target performance is obtained. After each iteration, the updated parameters are saved in the parameters table **1310**.

(205) FIG. **16** shows exemplary graphs that illustrate the operation of the system to adjust LLR generation based on received SINR for difference modulation schemes. The graph **1602** shows a plot of the mean of the absolute value of the LLR values (e.g., mean (abs (LLR))) versus a signal to interference noise ratio (SINR). The graph **1604** shows a plot of the variance of the absolute value

of the LLR values (e.g., $\text{var}(\text{abs}(\text{LLR}))$) versus the SINR. For example, the plots depict the LLR ranges generated by the LLR generator for a certain fixed configuration for different SINR values. In an embodiment, the `LLR_bit_width` parameter controls the upper and lower saturation limits of the LLRs, whereas the shift values `RSFT1` and `RSFT2` move the curves along the SINR axis determining where the saturation takes place. For each decoder type, these curves are carefully shaped for optimal performance. Having different internal implementation, each decoder that the LLR generator feeds requires a different set of soft-demapping configuration parameters. These optimal configuration parameters for each decoder will be generated by the machine learning algorithm **1314** with minimal or no external intervention. The machine learning algorithm **1314** receives feedback from the decoders in the form of performance metrics in order to drive the optimization process to achieve target performance.

(206) FIG. **17** shows an exemplary method **1700** for utilizing machine learning to optimize performance in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a decoder system. For example, the method **1700** is suitable for use with the portion of the descrambling and combining system shown in FIG. **12**.

(207) At block **1702**, a stream of data, CSI2, and padding LLRs are received.

(208) At block **1704**, soft-demapping is performed using soft-demapping parameters as part of LLR processing to generate raw LLRs.

(209) At block **1706**, the raw LLRs are decoded by a selected decoder.

(210) At block **1708**, a performance metric and a target performance are determined. For example, the performance metric is determined by the performance metric circuit **1306** and the target performance **1308** is stored in the memory **1304**.

(211) At block **1710**, a determination is made as to whether the performance metric meets the target performance. If the performance metric meets the performance target, the method ends. If the performance metric does not meet the performance target, the method proceeds to block **1712**.

(212) At block **1712**, a machine learning algorithm is performed to adjust the soft-demapping parameters to move performance metric toward performance target. For example, the machine learning algorithm **1314** is performed.

(213) At block **1714**, the parameter table is updated with the updated soft-demapping parameters. For example, the parameters table **1310** is updated with the newly determined soft-demapper parameters. The method then proceeds to block **1702** to receive and process more of the received stream.

(214) Thus, the method **1700** operates to utilize machine learning to optimize performance in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a decoder system. It should be noted that the operations of the method **1700** could be modified, added to, deleted, combined, rearranged, or otherwise changed within the scope of the embodiments.

(215) FIG. **18** shows an exemplary method **1800** for performing a machine learning algorithm in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a machine learning circuit. For example, the method **1800** is suitable for use at block **1712** in FIG. **17**. In an embodiment, the method **1800** is performed by the machine learning circuit **250** shown in FIG. **13**.

(216) At block **1802**, a determination is made as to whether this is the first pass through the machine learning process for the selected decoder and MCS. If it is the first pass through, the method proceeds to block **1804**. If it is not the first pass through, the method proceeds to block **1808**.

(217) At block **1804**, the parameters values are adjusted to obtain LLR saturation for the selected decoder/MCS. For example, the parameters are set so that all multipliers are maximized and all dividers are minimized in the demapping circuit **1500** to force the LLRs into saturation for the selected decoder/MCS.

(218) At block **1806**, an `LLR_bit_width` value is determined for the selected decoder/MCS based on the LLR saturation level. The bit-width value is selected to avoid saturation.

(219) At block **1808**, a target performance for the selected decoder/MCS is obtained from the memory **1304**. For example, the target performance **1308** is obtained from the memory **1304**.

(220) At block **1808**, a performance metric for the selected decoder/MCS is obtained. For example, the performance metric circuit **1306** determines a performance metric for the selected decoder/MCS by analyzing decoded data **252**. In an embodiment, the performance metric is a BLER value.

(221) At block **1812**, a machining learning algorithm is performed to adjust the soft-demapping parameters to move the performance metric toward target performance. In an embodiment, the MLC **250** performs the machine learning algorithm **1314** based on a reinforcement learning process to generate the updated parameters **256** to achieve the desired target performance. The determined soft-demapper parameters are pass to block **1714** where they are stored in the parameter table **1310**.

(222) Thus, the method **1800** operates to perform a machine learning algorithm to optimize performance in accordance with exemplary embodiments of a decoder system. It should be noted that the operations of the method **1800** could be modified, added to, deleted, combined, rearranged, or otherwise changed within the scope of the embodiments.

(223) FIG. **19** shows a block diagram illustrating a processing system **1900** having an exemplary embodiment of a decoder system **1930** that includes a machine learning circuit that adjust soft-demapping parameters to obtain a performance target for selected decoders. For example, in an embodiment, the decoder system **1930** includes the machine learning circuit **250** shown in FIG. **2**. It will be apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art that other alternative computer system architectures may also be employed.

(224) The system **1900** includes a processing unit **1901**, an interface bus **1912**, and an input/output (“IO”) unit **1920**. Processing unit **1901** includes a processor **1902**, main memory **1904**, system bus **1911**, static memory device **1906**, bus control unit **1909**, mass storage memory **1908**, and the decoder system **1930**. Bus **1911** is used to transmit information between various components and processor **1902** for data processing. Processor **1902** may be any of a wide variety of general-purpose processors, embedded processors, or microprocessors such as ARM® embedded processors, Intel® Core™2 Duo, Core™2 Quad, Xeon®, Pentium™ microprocessor, AMD® family processors, MIPS® embedded processors, or Power PC™ microprocessor.

(225) Main memory **1904**, which may include multiple levels of cache memories, stores frequently used data and instructions. Main memory **1904** may be RAM (random access memory), MRAM (magnetic RAM), or flash memory. Static memory **1906** may be a ROM (read-only memory), which is coupled to bus **1911**, for storing static information and/or instructions. Bus control unit **1909** is coupled to buses **1911-1912** and controls which component, such as main memory **1904** or processor **1902**, can use the bus. Mass storage memory **1908** may be a magnetic disk, solid-state drive (“SSD”), optical disk, hard disk drive, floppy disk, CD-ROM, and/or flash memories for storing large amounts of data.

(226) I/O unit **1920**, in one example, includes a display **1921**, keyboard **1922**, cursor control device **1923**, and communication device **1929**. Display device **1921** may be a liquid crystal device, flat panel monitor, cathode ray tube (“CRT”), touch-screen display, or other suitable display device. Display **1921** projects or displays graphical images or windows. Keyboard **1922** can be a conventional alphanumeric input device for communicating information between computer system **1900** and computer operators. Another type of user input device is cursor control device **1923**, such as a mouse, touch mouse, trackball, or other type of cursor for communicating information between system **1900** and users.

(227) Communication device **1929** is coupled to bus **1912** for accessing information from remote computers or servers through wide-area network. Communication device **1929** may include a modem, a router, or a network interface device, or other similar devices that facilitate communication between computer **1900** and the network. In one aspect, communication device **1929** is configured to perform wireless functions. Alternatively, decoder system **1930** and

communication device **1929** perform resource element categorization, descrambling and combining, decoding, and machine learning optimization functions in accordance with embodiments of the present invention.

(228) The decoder system **1930**, in one aspect, is coupled to bus **1911** and is configured to perform decoding and machine learning and optimization functions on received uplink communications as described above to improve overall receiver performance. In an embodiment, the decoder system **1930** comprises hardware, firmware, or a combination of hardware and firmware.

(229) In an embodiment, an apparatus is provided that includes means for soft-demapping resource elements based on soft-demapping parameters as part of a process to generate log-likelihood ratios (LLR) values, which in an embodiment comprises the soft-demapper **216**. The apparatus also includes means for decoding the LLRs to generate decoded data, which in an embodiment comprises the decoder system **156**. The apparatus also includes means for identifying a target performance value, means for determining a performance metric from the decoded data, and means for performing a machine learning algorithm that dynamically adjusts the soft-demapping parameters to move the performance metric toward the target performance value, which in an embodiment comprises the machine learning circuit **250**.

(230) While particular embodiments of the present invention have been shown and described, it will be obvious to those skilled in the art that, based upon the teachings herein, changes and modifications may be made without departing from the exemplary embodiments of the present invention and its broader aspects. Therefore, the appended claims are intended to encompass within their scope all such changes and modifications as are within the true spirit and scope of this exemplary embodiments of the present invention.

Claims

1. An apparatus for processing data transmitted via a communication network, comprising: a soft-demapper configured to generate log-likelihood ratios (LLR) values via soft-demapping resource elements in accordance with soft-demapping parameters; a decoder coupled to the soft-demapper and configured to generate decoded data based on the LLR values; a performance metric circuit coupled to the decoder and identifying a performance metric from the decoded data; and a processor coupled to the performance metric circuit and configured to adjust one or more soft-demapping parameters in response to the performance metric and a target performance in accordance with an operation of a machine learning algorithm, wherein the processor is able to update the soft-demapping parameters based on a selected LLR bit-width value via performance of the machine learning algorithm.
2. The apparatus of claim 1, further comprising a base station front end coupled to the soft-demapper and configured to obtain the resource elements derived from symbols received in a new radio (NR) uplink transmission.
3. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the soft-demapping parameters include a modulation scale (MOD_SCALE) value.
4. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the soft-demapping parameters include a first shift (RSFT1) value.
5. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the soft-demapping parameters include a second shift (RSFT2) value.
6. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the soft-demapping parameters include an LLR offset value.
7. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the soft-demapping parameters include an LLR bit-width value.
8. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the processor is able to adjust the soft-demapping parameters to determine an LLR saturation level via execution of the machine learning algorithm.
9. The apparatus of claim 1, wherein the processor is capable of performing an iterative process of

machine learning algorithm to update the soft-demapping parameters in accordance with the target performance.

10. A method for processing data transmitted via a communication network, comprising: generating log-likelihood ratios (LLR) values via soft-demapping resource elements in accordance with soft-demapping parameters; activating a decoder to generate decoded data based on the LLR values; identifying a performance metric in response to the decoded data; adjusting one or more soft-demapping parameters in response to the performance metric and a target performance in accordance with an operation of a machine learning algorithm; and updating the soft-demapping parameters based on a selected LLR bit-width value via performance of the machine learning algorithm.

11. The method of claim 10, further comprising obtaining resource elements derived from symbols received in a new radio (NR) uplink transmission.

12. The method of claim 10, further comprising identifying a modulation scale (MOD_SCALE) value in accordance with the soft-demapping parameters.

13. The method of claim 10, further comprising identifying a first shift (RSFT1) value in accordance with the soft-demapping parameters.

14. The method of claim 10, further comprising identifying a second shift (RSFT2) value in accordance with the soft-demapping parameters.

15. The method of claim 10, further comprising identifying an LLR offset value in response to the soft-demapping parameters.

16. The method of claim 10, further comprising identifying an LLR bit-width value in response to the soft-demapping parameters.

17. The method of claim 10, further comprising adjusting the soft-demapping parameters to determine an LLR saturation level via execution of the machine learning algorithm.

18. The method of claim 10, further comprising performing an iterative process of machine learning algorithm to update the soft-demapping parameters in accordance with the target performance.

19. An apparatus for processing data transmitted via a communication network, comprising: means for generating log-likelihood ratios (LLR) values via soft-demapping resource elements in accordance with soft-demapping parameters; means for activating a decoder to generate decoded data based on the LLR values; means for identifying a performance metric in response to the decoded data; means for adjusting one or more soft-demapping parameters in response to the performance metric and a target performance in accordance with an operation of a machine learning algorithm; and means for adjusting the soft-demapping parameters based on a selected LLR bit-width value via performance of a machine learning circuit for identifying a performance value.

20. The apparatus of claim 19, further comprising means for obtaining resource elements derived from symbols received in a new radio (NR) uplink transmission.

21. The apparatus of claim 19, further comprising means for identifying a modulation scale (MOD_SCALE) value in accordance with the soft-demapping parameters.

22. The apparatus of claim 19, further comprising means for identifying a first shift (RSFT1) value in accordance with the soft-demapping parameters.

23. The apparatus of claim 19, further comprising means for identifying a second shift (RSFT2) value in accordance with the soft-demapping parameters.

24. The apparatus of claim 19, further comprising means for identifying an LLR offset value in response to the soft-demapping parameters.

25. The apparatus of claim 19, further comprising means for identifying an LLR bit-width value in response to the soft-demapping parameters.
